

A Patient Roadmap: First 30 Days After a Sarcoma Diagnosis

Quick Tips Care Guide



Being newly diagnosed with leiomyosarcoma or another soft tissue sarcoma can feel overwhelming. This guide helps you focus on the most important steps during the first month.

Week 1: Understanding Your Diagnosis

- Take a deep breath—feeling anxious or confused is normal.
- Gather your medical records: pathology reports, scans, lab results.
- Ask for clarification from your doctor if any terms or results are unclear.
- Consider bringing a family member or friend to appointments for support and note-taking.

Key Question: “Can someone explain my pathology and tumor type in plain language?”

Week 2: Find the Right Care Team

- Ask whether your case should be reviewed at a sarcoma specialty center.
- Schedule visits with:
 - Surgical oncologist
 - Medical oncologist
 - Radiation oncologist
- Make a list of all your doctors and their contact information.

Tip: Don’t hesitate to seek a second opinion—this is normal and often encouraged.

Week 3: Plan Your Next Steps

- Discuss your treatment options: surgery, radiation, systemic therapy, or a combination.
- Ask about timing, goals, and side effects for each option.
- Understand whether imaging or scans will be needed before treatment begins.
- Begin organizing logistics: transportation, home support, and work/family responsibilities.

Key Question: “What is the recommended treatment sequence for my tumor type and location?”

Week 4: Emotional and Practical Support

- Connect with a support group or patient advocate—many organizations offer sarcoma-specific support.
- Write down questions as they arise; bring them to appointments.
- Take small steps each day to manage stress: walking, journaling, meditation, or hobbies.
- Discuss caregiving plans with family or friends to ensure help is available when needed.

Caregiver Tip: Help track appointments, medications, and side effects—this is invaluable to the patient.

Key Takeaways

- Focus on understanding your diagnosis first, then building your care team.
- Ask questions—clarity helps reduce anxiety.
- Keep records organized for yourself and your doctors.

- Emotional support is as important as medical care.
- One step at a time—recovery and treatment planning is a marathon, not a sprint.

Trusted Resources

- [National Leiomyosarcoma Foundation \(NLMSF\)](https://www.nlmsf.org)



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Sarcoma & LMS Pathways

Care Guide - Quick Tips for Patients & Families

Trusted guidance for navigating diagnosis, treatment, and leiomyosarcoma

[www.NLMSF.org](https://www.nlmsf.org)